Release notes for ICB, v15
20 March 2023

Update on 31 May 2023: We discovered a typo after the first release of v15. Iran's major response for crisis 488 should be a "2" (verbal threat) rather than a "1."

Appreciation:
This update to the ICB data would not have been possible without the dedicated work of David Kennedy (ICB Project Manager), Anisha Datta, Rebecca Dudley, Josh Frakes, Paul Framel, Corinne DeFrancisci, Xiaoxiao Li, Yueyi Li, Diana Partridge, Megan Rutter, Xiangyu Song, Yuan Tien, Beth Vander Hoek, and Yu Xia.

New cases:
474 Houthi rebellion (Note that UAE has a nonconsecutive actor ID because we did not reserved a placeholder value for UAE like we did for Saudi Arabia.)
488 Israel-Iran clashes in Syria
489 Syria Chemical Weapons III
490 UAE withdrawal from Somalia
491 Sea of Azov
492 Israel-Iran clashes in Syria II
493 Venezuelan election
494 Pulwama suicide bombing
495 Soleimani assassination
496 Abqaiq Oil Strike

Revisions to previous cases:

We updated the OUTESR and 5-year-change variables for previous cases in which we have sufficient recent information about whether the actors have returned to crisis.

The ICB Dyads dataset was edited so that the STATEA values are less than the STATEB values.

Crisis #201: For consistency with the source materials, we changed the response date for Kenya to 12/28/1963 and updated the corresponding duration variables and the summary.

Crises #210 and #213: Brecher and Wilkenfeld earlier had decided that these two cases were miscoded, as North Vietnam is a more accurate source of threat to the USA than the USSR. We changed SOUTHV and SOUTHPOW for USA to DRV (North Vietnam).

Crisis #211: With evidence that China was the key international supporter of the NLC, the SOUTHV for the DRC was changed from the USSR to China. We also changed the SOUTHV for Belgium from the DRC to the USSR, to parallel the SOUTHV coding for the USA. The SOUTHPOW variable was also adjusted for these actors. Moreover, the POWDIS variable was adjusted for all crisis actors, to account for the USSR and China acting as a coalition against the DRC, USA and

Belgium. The crisis summary was also lightly edited to highlight the important role of China's support, and also to clarify the threat perceptions of the USA and Belgium. In light of these changes, the dyad data were updated to include China as a key adversary of the DRC, USA and Belgium. Finally, we discovered that the actor ID for the DRC was mis-entered in the dyad data, and so we have made that correction.

Crisis #225: The MAJRES for USA was changed to 7, to reflect that the major response was not escalatory but de-escalatory.

Crisis #241: The original coding of having South Vietnam as the source of threat for Laos does not well capture that Laos and South Vietnam were fighting against Communist insurgencies. We changed the SOUTHV for Laos to North Vietnam, and made the corresponding adjustments to the SOUTHPOW and POWDIS variables.

Crisis #267: The summary was edited to reflect that Mozambique's major response did not actually involve combat against the Rhodesian forces.

Crisis #272: To reflect the summary, the date of Greece's major response was changed to 08/12/1976.

Crisis #291: To resolve a discrepancy between the summary and the coding for MAJRES, we changed MAJRES for Angola to 7, and we updated the summary to reflect the mobilization of Angolan forces but without direct combat against the South African forces.

Crisis #293: To resolve a discrepancy between the summary and the coding for MAJRES, we updated the summary to reflect that Zambia did not pursue military escalation in response to the crisis trigger.

Crisis #303: We updated the summary to reflect the importance of covert support for the Mujahuddin as part of the USA response.

Crisis #310: To resolve a problem of having Nicaragua's response date prior to its trigger date, we identified 2/14/1980 as its response date. We also updated the duration variables and the summary.

Crisis #316: To resolve a discrepancy between the summary and the MAJRES coding, Malta's MAJRES was changed to 6 and the response date was changed to 8/26/1980. We also updated the duration variables.

Crisis #320: After further investigation into the major response for Ethiopia and Kenya, we updated the MAJRES to 6, with a 12/27/1980 date. We also updated the duration variables and the summary.

Crisis #326: For consistency with the summary, Nicaragua's MAJRES was changed to 6.

Crisis #361: The response dates for Iraq and Iran appear to have been mis-entered. We have updated both to be 2/14/1986.

Crisis #363: For consistency with the summary, we recoded the MAJRES for Libya to 9 and the response date as 3/24/1986. We also updated the duration variables.

Crisis #393: The year of Iraq's major response was mis-entered. It was been updated to 1991.

Crisis #410: For consistency with the summary, we recoded the MAJRES for Nigeria to 8.

Crisis #471: The spelling of "Donbass" was changed to "Donbas." To reflect that a crisis had recurred between the actors within five years, OUTESR was updated from 2 to 1 in the actor and system levels. The five-year change variables were also updated to indicate that this is an interim case.